

Lakeview Pain and Spine Center

4100 Monroe St, Toledo, OH 43606 · Ph (419) 555-0140 · Fax (419) 555-0141

Prior Authorization Request - Procedure

Health plan: Humana Medicare Advantage · Standard pre-service review

Date of request: 10/07/2026
Member name: Gary Novak
Date of birth: 05/02/1960 (age 66) Sex: M
Member ID: MBR-43003
Requesting MD: Dr. Meera Iyer, MD - Pain Medicine
NPI: 1588203741
Practice: Lakeview Pain and Spine Center
Requested service: Permanent spinal cord stimulator implant (pulse generator and percutaneous leads)
CPT: 63685
ICD-10: G89.4, M96.1 (Post-laminectomy syndrome)
Planned procedure date: 11/12/2026
Place of service: Hospital outpatient department, St. Anne Regional Hospital (outpatient surgery)
Submitted by: Dana Pruitt, Authorization Coordinator (419) 555-0140

Supporting clinical documentation attached (4 pages including this request).

Pt eager to proceed - DP

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Pain Medicine Consultation

Date: 08/18/2026 Patient: Gary Novak, age 66

History

Failed back surgery syndrome after L4-L5 fusion in 2022. Chronic intractable low back and leg pain for 3 years. Pain is neuropathic, radiating down the left leg. Average pain NRS 8/10.

Conservative treatment tried

Gabapentin and duloxetine for over 12 months, physical therapy 24 visits in 2025, two epidural steroid injections and a medial branch block, and 8 sessions of pain psychology (CBT for chronic pain). None gave lasting relief.

Screening

Evaluated by our multidisciplinary team: pain medicine (history and full physical and neurologic exam), physical therapy, and a psychological evaluation by Dr. Paul Grant, PhD (report attached). MRI reviewed: no new surgical lesion.

Substance use

No current or past substance use disorder. Urine drug screen 8/18/26 consistent with prescribed medicines only.

Education

We had an extensive discussion of the risks and benefits of spinal cord stimulation, the trial, the permanent implant and the alternatives. Written materials given. Patient understands and wants to proceed.

Plan

Spinal cord stimulator trial, then a permanent implant if the trial is positive. The permanent implant will be done in: Hospital outpatient department, St. Anne Regional Hospital (outpatient surgery).

Meera Iyer MD 8/18/26

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Psychological Evaluation - Pre-SCS

Date: 08/26/2026 Patient: Gary Novak Evaluator: Dr. Paul Grant, PhD, Clinical Psychologist

Psychological screening for spinal cord stimulation completed: clinical interview, PHQ-9 (6, mild), GAD-7 (4), Pain Catastrophizing Scale (18).

No untreated major depression, psychosis or cognitive impairment. Realistic expectations of the therapy. No current or past substance use disorder.

Conclusion

Psychologically cleared to proceed with a spinal cord stimulator trial and implant.

P. Grant PhD

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Spinal Cord Stimulator Trial Report

Trial dates: 09/14/2026 to 09/21/2026 (7 days) Patient: Gary Novak Member ID MBR-43003

Trial

Percutaneous trial with two temporary epidural leads at T8 to T10, placed in the hospital outpatient department. This was the patient's first spinal cord stimulator trial. No prior SCS trials in any spinal region.

Pain

Target pain NRS 8/10 before the trial and 3/10 during the trial: a 63% reduction in target pain.

Medication

Oxycodone reduced from 30 mg a day before the trial to 10 mg a day during the trial (a 67% reduction).

Function

Functional improvement: walking tolerance went from 2 blocks to 1 mile, sitting from 20 minutes to 1 hour, and sleep from 4 to 7 hours.

Result

Positive trial. The patient experienced a clear positive response and wants to proceed to the permanent implant.

Meera Iyer MD 9/22/26